

Is AI all bad for the environment?

Posted by u/Amazing_Cat8897 • 0 points • 104 comments

I used to use AI art and roleplay programs for personal use until my friend showed me a video on how dangerous AI is for the environment and people around the generators, but it also has me wondering if ALL programs are this bad and generate this much power. Just recently, I found an AIDungeon program for my phone that was apparently made in 2019, and while image generation is optional, you can play with just words, with a few pre-generated ideas and whatnot. How bad would a program like this be compared to other AI generated programs?

Comments

u/Prize-Psychology-195 • 1 points • 2026-03-28 15:36 UTC

Hi b&s

I'm wasted artist and I'd to say that I am also trying not to be redundant about this subject, which is how AI could contribute to the well-being of the earth, but in fact going straight to the bottom of the question I thought it was very absurd to say that the ecosia search engine helped plant plants, but their A.i. nope. So I was wondering if there is an artificial intelligence that directly contributes, as Ocean Heroes search engine has done, to helping the planet as well as cleaning the oceans, that has the same intent that contributes to the environmental impact of helping the ecosystems of nature. Have you seen this perspective of things before or have other people found one of the AI that does this, that is, contribute to helping nature?

u/Prize-Psychology-195 • 1 points • 2026-03-28 15:30 UTC

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u/russemeptd • 1 points • 2026-03-25 13:48 UTC

Honest opinion, AI should exclusively be used as a way to develop technology and should not be available for public use to lazily skim data and create stupid photos online. Is the energy and water

consumed to run your program really worth the long term environmental impact? Can we as a society not take the extra time to use our brains? The future is bleak.

u/ThrowawayALAT • 1 points • 2025-11-19 08:27 UTC

You're right to wonder—**not all AI programs are equally "bad" for the environment**. It really depends on the **type of AI**, how it's hosted, and how much computation it uses. Here's a breakdown:

1. Text-based AI vs. Image/Video AI

- * **Text-only AI** (like AIDungeon or ChatGPT-style roleplay tools) uses far **less computation** than image generators.
- * Generating an image can require **tens to hundreds of times more GPU power**, because it involves huge neural networks running lots of calculations for every pixel.
- * So your phone-based AIDungeon, especially if it mostly uses pre-generated ideas, is **environmentally light** compared to MidJourney, DALL·E, or Stable Diffusion.

2. Things that are much worse for the environment than text AI

- * **Mining cryptocurrency** like Bitcoin — uses massive amounts of electricity 24/7.
- * **Streaming 4K/8K video** all day — servers, cooling, and networks consume huge power.
- * **Gaming on cloud platforms** (like Stadia or GeForce Now) if used extensively — GPUs run full tilt.
- * **AI training of huge models** — the one-time training phase of GPT-4-sized models uses enormous energy, far beyond personal usage.

Summary

- * Using **text-only AI** on a phone or lightweight servers is negligible in terms of environmental impact.
- * **Big image, video, or large-model training AIs** are what really generate high electricity usage.
- * So in defense of AI: small-scale, personal AI tools are **far greener than many everyday tech habits**, and not all AI is inherently "bad" for the planet.

u/thefriendlyhacker • 1 points • 2025-11-18 13:39 UTC

Data centers are bad, which AI accelerates the use of. For example, keeping a post on your Instagram page is equivalent to letting a lightbulb run for 100 years or so

u/jeffwulf • 2 points • 2025-11-18 01:57 UTC

Use of AI has the same environmental effects as playing Elden Ring for the same ammount of time.

u/lightskinloki • 1 points • 2025-11-17 16:30 UTC

It depends on the scale you look at. Compared to if it didnt exist? Yes its quite bad. Compared to say any social media site? Not at all. You'd have to prompt chatgpt nonstop for several years to equal the same environmental and water usage impact as producing and consuming a single cheeseburger. That said millions of people are using chat gpt every day. So to answer your question it is quite complex and depends on the scale you are talking about, as a general rule if you are worried about this avoid cloud

based ai inference. If you use a local model you'll see even if you are doing video and image generation for hours a day it is no worse than playing a video game.

u/Amazing_Cat8897 • 2 points • 2025-11-17 17:02 UTC

Any AI RP programs you'd reccomend?

u/lightskinloki • 1 points • 2025-11-17 17:05 UTC

If you can run it a quantized kimi k2 is great for local rp and creative writing. Qwen3 is also decent but its not quite as creative. Some of the old uncensored wizard and falcon models are still pretty good too.

u/Hel_OWeen • 1 points • 2025-11-17 10:17 UTC

The fact that computational power is no longer measured/listed in (terra)flops, but gigawatt, is a pretty telling sign.